

Ἀνώνυμος παρωδός (Βατραχομυομαχία)

The Battle of Frogs and Mice by Parodist Anonymous

eul_aid: mje

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Ἑπική [Epic \(Homeric\)](#)

Domain: Ποίσις [Poetry](#)

Format: Ἑμμετρος [Verse](#)

Parodist Anonymous is the conventional designation for the author of the *Batrachomyomachia*. No biographical details survive. Ancient tradition variously, and spuriously, attributed the poem to Homer or to Pigres of Halicarnassus.

The work's language and style indicate a Hellenistic date of composition, likely in the 3rd or 2nd century BCE, by an author thoroughly versed in Homeric epic. The primary work is the *Batrachomyomachia*, a complete mock-epic parody of Homeric style. A lost poem, the *Psaromachia*, is also sometimes linked to this anonymous parodist.

The *Batrachomyomachia* is a significant early example of literary parody, underscoring the foundational role of Homeric poetry in ancient culture. Its popularity is attested by its survival in numerous manuscripts and its historical use as a school text for Homeric Greek. The poem influenced the later mock-heroic tradition.

Works (2)

- [Βατραχομυομαχία · Battle of Frogs and Mice](#) · 270 passages
- [Βατραχομυομαχία · Battle of Frogs and Mice, Byzantine Prosody](#) · 42 passages